including both the issuance protocol (OpenID4VCI) and the presentation protocol (OpenID4VP). These protocols reuse OAuth and OpenID Connect conventions for transport, discovery, and authentication flows, making them appealing because of their familiarity to developers.

> ***NOTE***
>
> This section touches on topics, like DID-based identifiers and OpenID4VC, that are complex and worthy of more discussion. I cover all of this in depth in my earlier book *Learning Digital Identity* (2023, O'Reilly Media).

Despite their differences, these protocols achieve the same authorization outcome: a signed presentation containing claims that can be verified using issuer keys and signatures. ACME's has chosen to ensure its verification process is able to accept and validate presentations delivered through various protocols. Nevertheless, the verification steps stay the same. The PEP verifies that claims come from trusted issuers listed in ACME's trust store, checks expiration and revocation status, and then passes normalized attributes to the PDP. The PEP enforces issuer trust during request assembly, but policies may still reference issuer sets when different actions require different trust scopes. From the PDP's perspective, it does not matter whether the credential was issued using a DID-based protocol, retrieved via an OpenID4VCI flow, or presented using OpenID4VP. Policies focus only on the attributes, not the specific protocol used to deliver them. (See the sidebar for how ACME maintains protocol flexibility in its verification layer.)

Different parts of ACME's ecosystem may rely on different combinations of issuance and presentation protocols. Credentials issued by ACME to its employees and long-term partners use the `did:scid` method (https://lf-toip.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/HOME/pages/88572360/DID+SCID+Method+Specification), which seamlessly integrates with ACME's web infrastructure and key management practices. External auditors, on the other hand, might receive their employment and certification credentials through OpenID4VC flows, supported by their employers and industry associations. Clinicians